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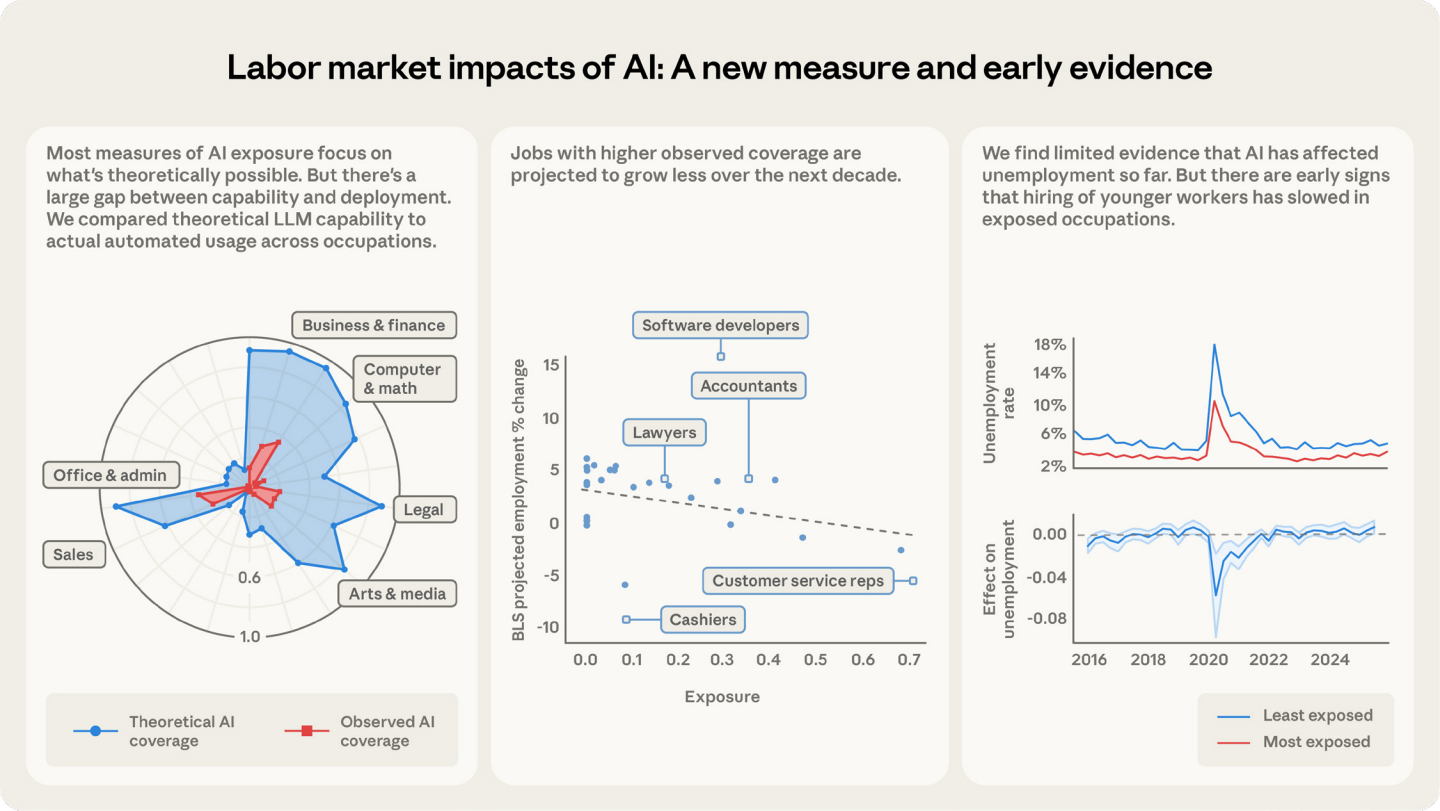
Labor market impacts of AI: A new measure and early evidence
Most measures of AI exposure focus on what's theoretically possible. But there's a large gap between capability and deployment. We compared theoretical LLM capability to actual automated usage across occupations.
Business & finance
Computer & math
Office & admin
Legal
Sales
Arts & media
0.6
1.0
Theoretical AI coverage
Observed AI coverage
Jobs with higher observed coverage are projected to grow less over the next decade.
Software developers
Accountants
Lawyers
Customer service reps
Cashiers
BLS projected employment % change
15
10
5
0
-5
-10
0.0
0.1
0.2
0.3
0.4
0.5
0.6
0.7
Exposure
We find limited evidence that AI has affected unemployment so far. But there are early signs that hiring of younger workers has slowed in exposed occupations.
Unemployment rate
18%
14%
10%
6%
2%
Effect on unemployment
0.00
-0.04
-0.08
2016
2018
2020
2022
2024
Least exposed
Most exposed

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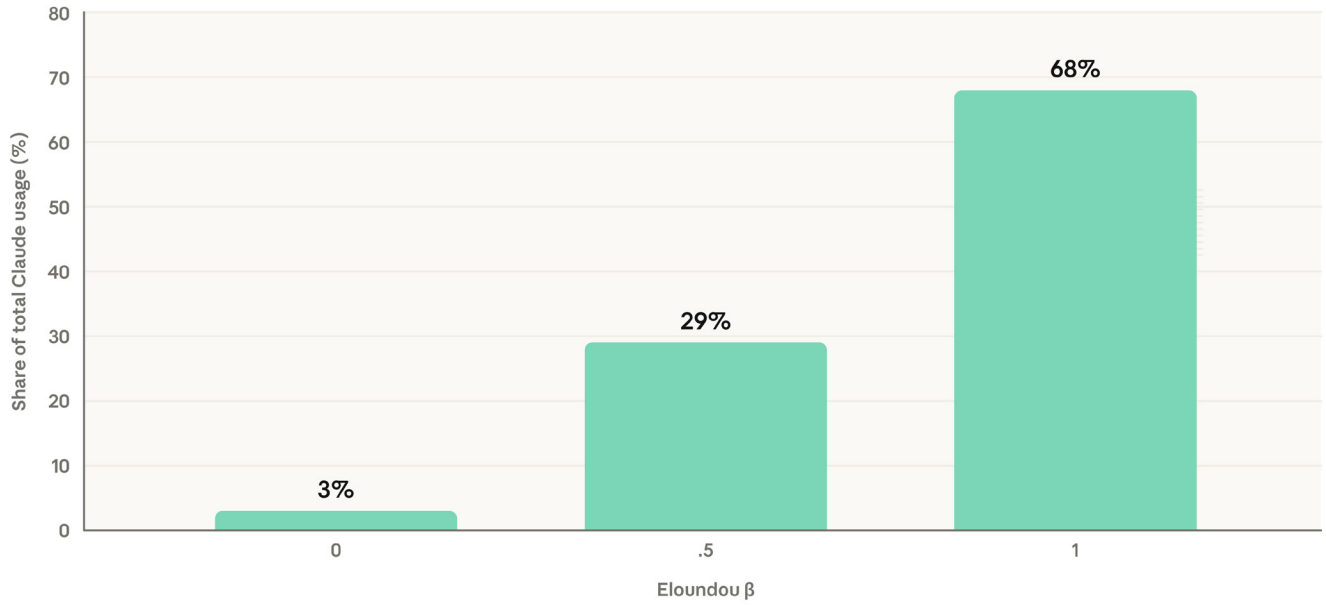
Share of Claude usage by Eloundou et al. exposure rating



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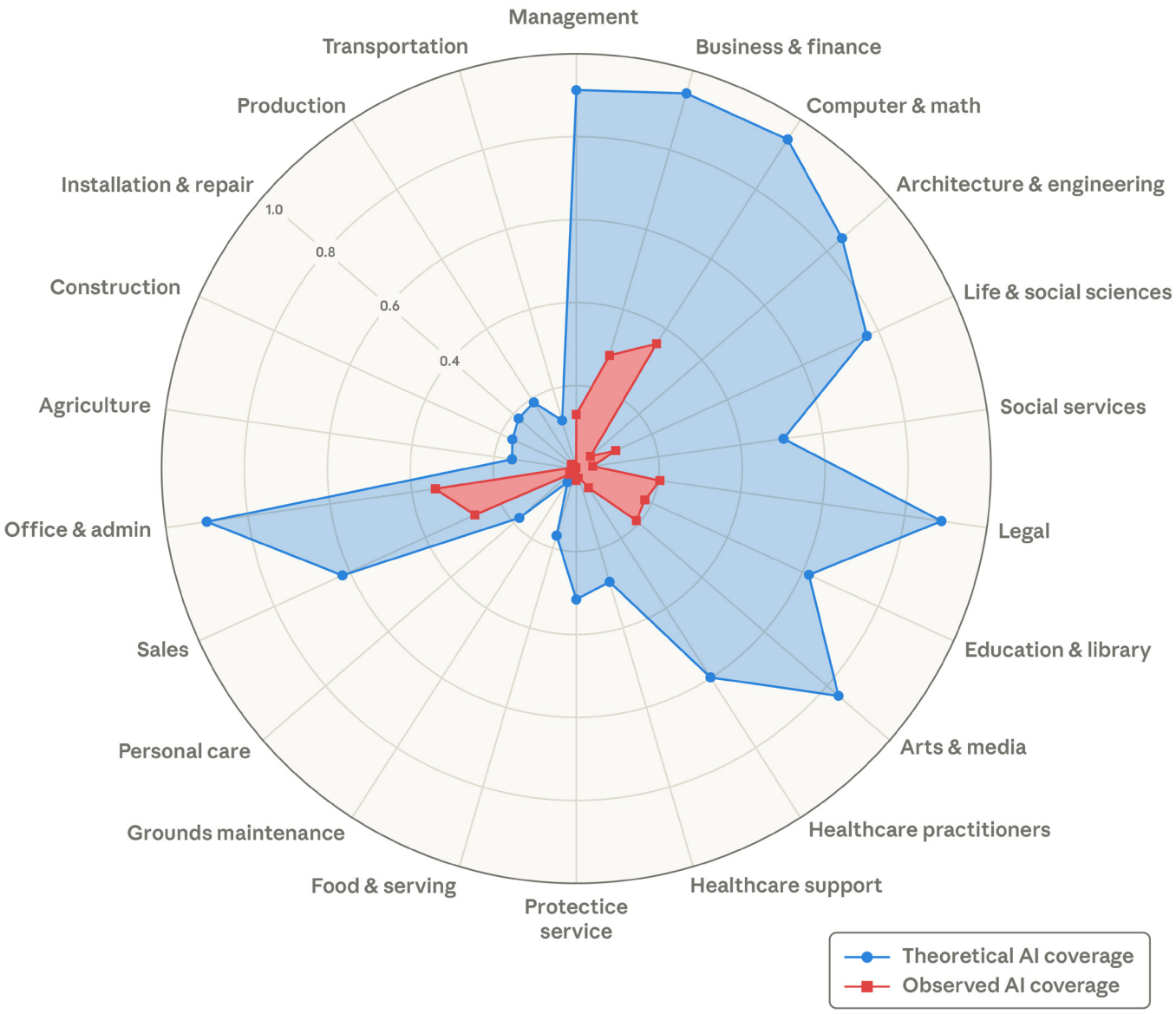
Theoretical capability and observed usage by occupational category



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Most exposed occupations

Occupation	Observed exposure	Leading automated task
Computer programmers	74.5%	Write, update, and maintain software programs
Customer service representatives	70.1%	Confer with customers to provide info, take orders, handle complaints
Data entry keyers	67.1%	Read source documents and enter data into systems
Medical record specialists	66.7%	Compile, abstract, and code patient data
Market research analysts and marketing specialists	64.8%	Prepare reports of findings, illustrating data graphically and translating complex findings into written text
Sales representatives, wholesale and manufacturing, except technical and scientific products	62.8%	Contact customers to demonstrate products and solicit orders
Financial and investment analysts	57.2%	Inform investment decisions by analyzing financial information to forecast business, industry, or economic conditions
Software quality assurance analysts and testers	51.9%	Modify software to correct errors or improve performance
Information security analysts	48.6%	Perform risk assessments and test data processing security
Computer user support specialists	46.8%	Answer user inquiries regarding computer software or hardware operation to resolve problems

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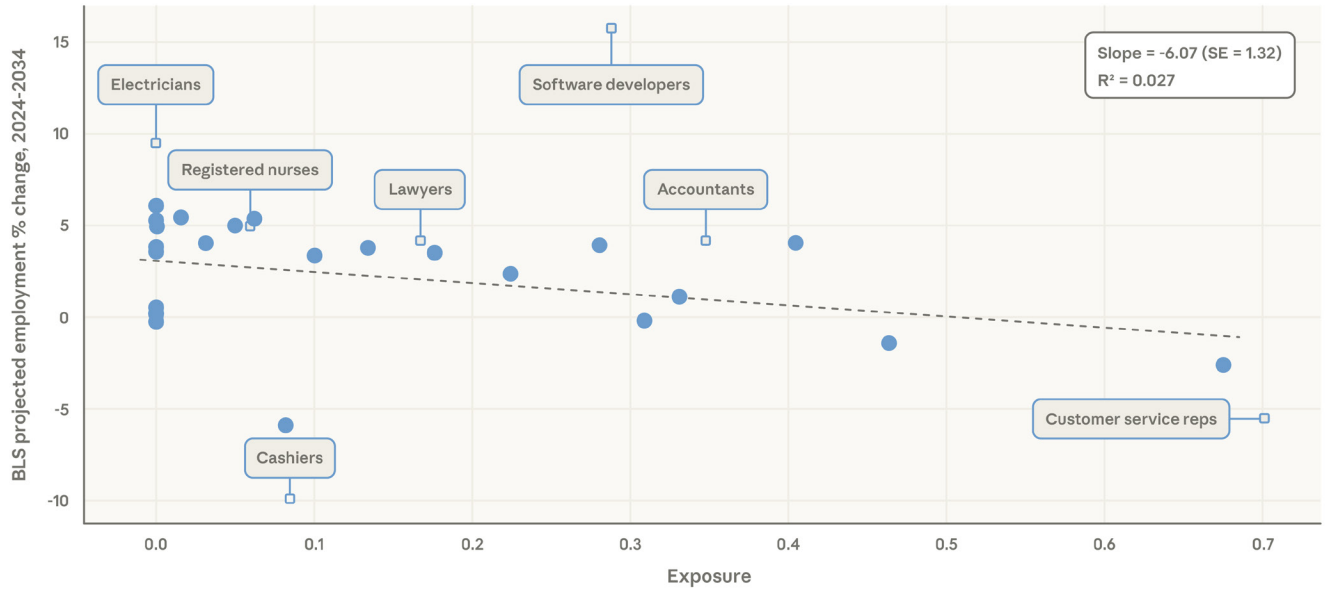
BLS projected employment growth from 2024–2034 vs. AI exposure



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Differences between high and low exposure workers

		No exposure	Top quartile	Difference
Exposure	AI coverage (%)	0.0%	38.8%	+38.8 pp
Demographics	Age	41.0	42.9	+1.9
	Female	38.8%	54.4%	+15.5
	Hispanic	24.8%	13.8%	-11.0 pp
	White, non-Hispanic	54.5%	65.1%	+10.6 pp
	Black, non-Hispanic	13.2%	9.7%	-3.5 pp
	Asian, non-Hispanic	4.7%	9.1%	+4.4 pp
	Married	44.6%	54.9%	+10.4 pp
Education	Less than HS	13.2%	2.3%	-10.9 pp
	HS diploma	38.9%	17.7%	-21.2 pp
	Some college / assoc.	30.0%	25.5%	-4.6 pp
	Bachelor's degree	13.3%	37.1%	+23.8 pp
	Graduate degree	4.5%	17.4%	+12.8 pp
Labor market	Hours / week	37.5	38.7	+1.2
	Hourly wage ($)	$22.23	$32.69	$+10.45
	Union member	11.7%	5.3%	-6.4 pp
	Observations	**42,546**	**32,301**	

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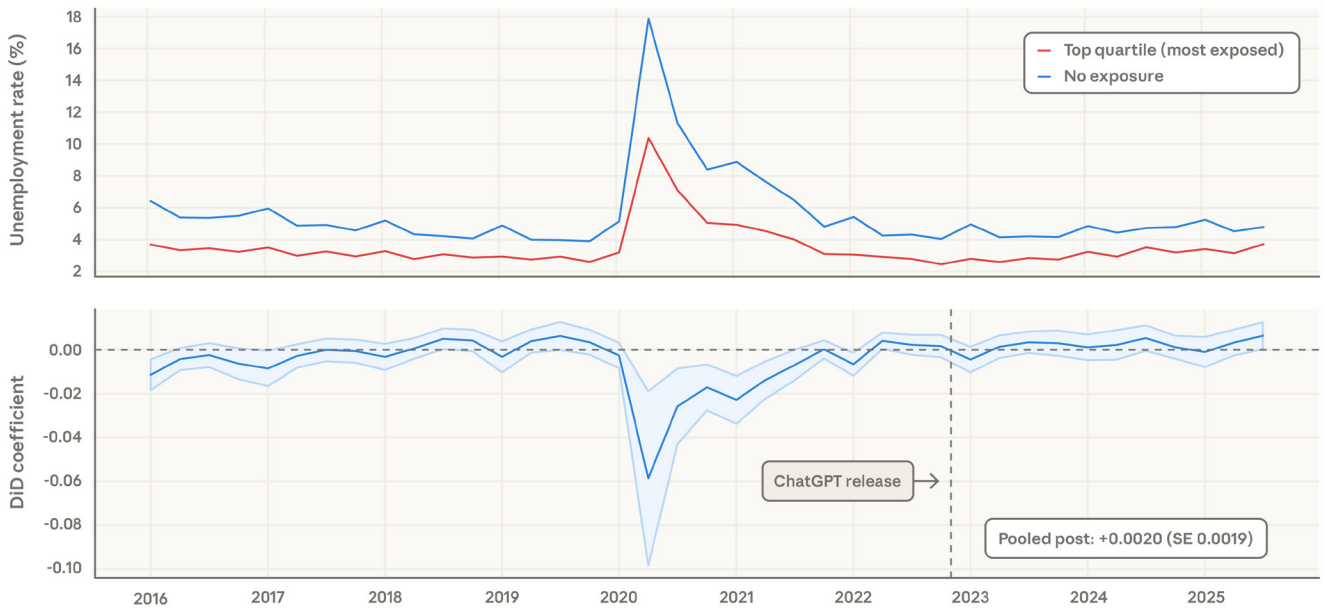
Trends in unemployment rate for workers with high AI exposure and no AI exposure



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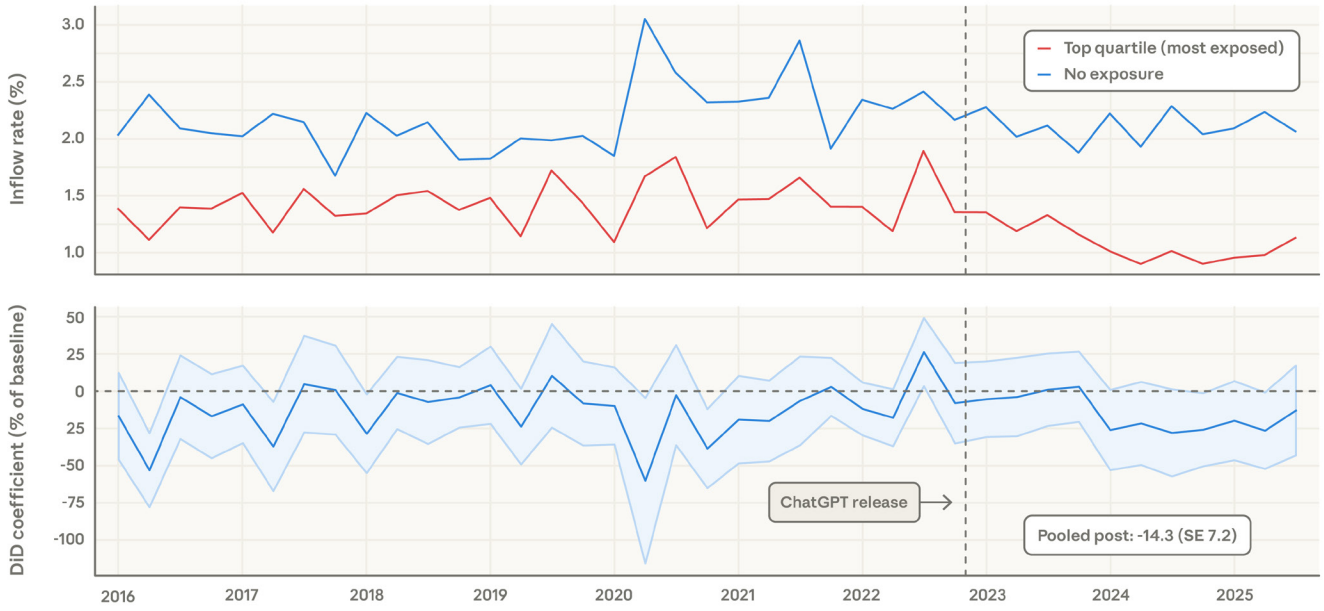
New job starts among workers age 22-25 in occupations with high and no AI exposure



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